VALENTINE'S ILLUMINATI & HALLMARK SPECIAL EDITION

+CCC+ RADIO

FOLLOW

I

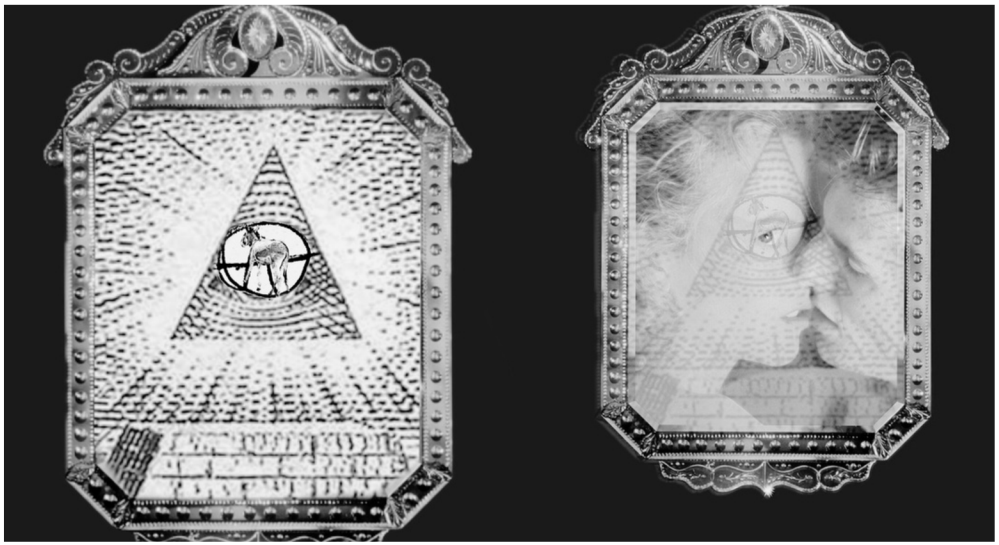
We are living in a moment in and of **Crisis**.
I say "Of" because there is an easily discernible chain of events leading up to this moment.
I say "In" because we, my strange friend, are ***IN*** it.
A close and strange friend told me that Our Streaming Services are too good for the people torevolt;
Where is our Tik Tok Eisenstein?

II

yellowHairScreamingLiesThroughaFuckinMega phonePukingPoliticalTerrorAsPower

III

"If at his council I should turn aside
Into that ominous tract which, all agree, Hides the Dark Tower." As a slop of broken men
Grasp at youth with cum-covered hooves.
"There they stood, ranged along the hill-sides—I saw them and I knew them all."
(Childe Roland).

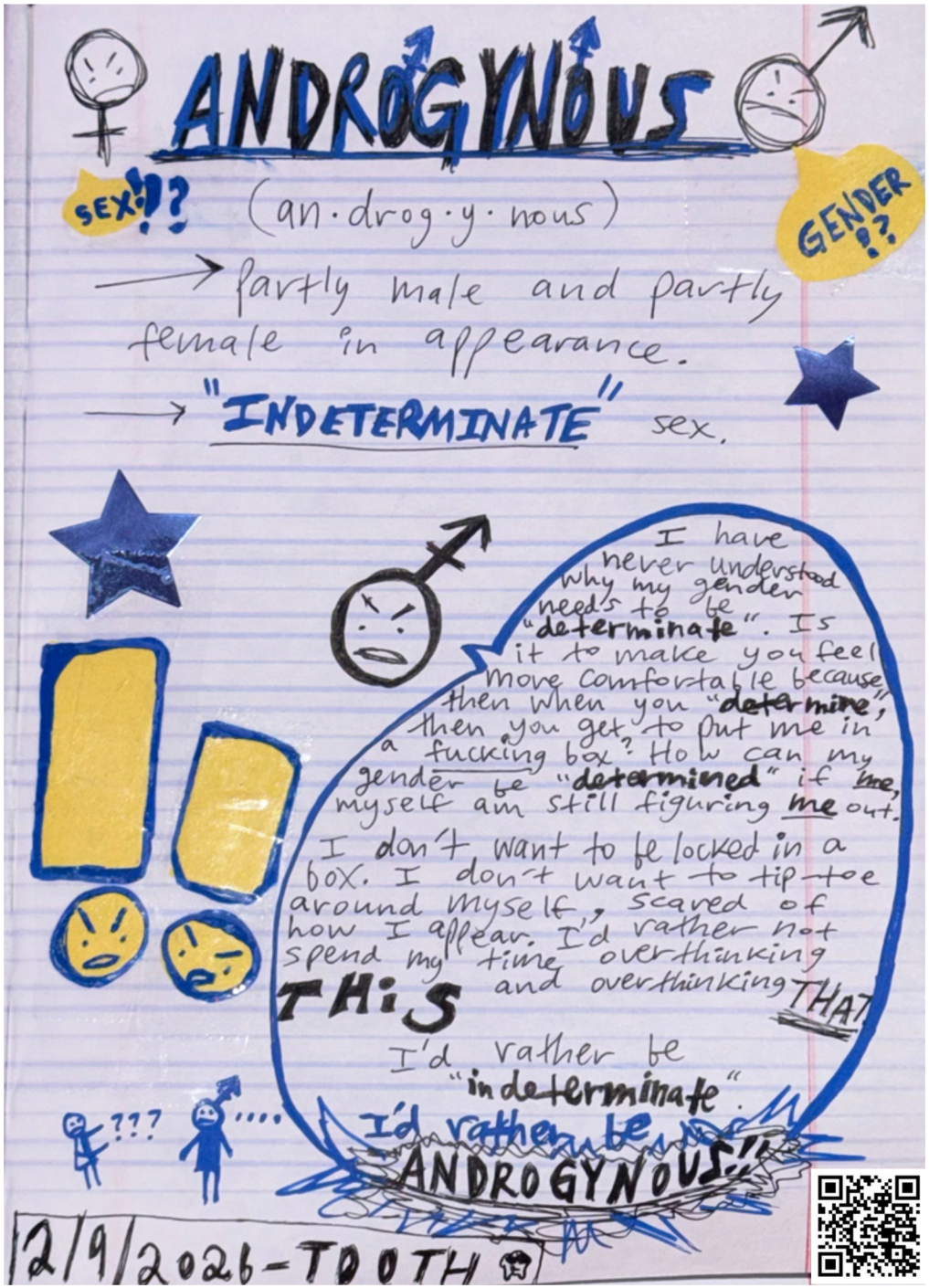


COUNTER CULTURE COLLECTIVE

UCXHC

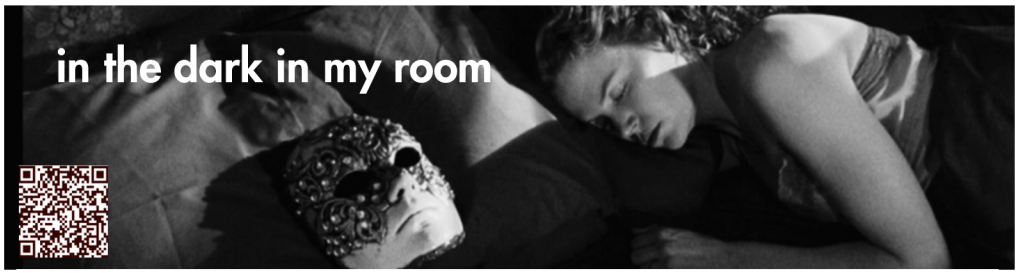
FEB '26

CCC#003



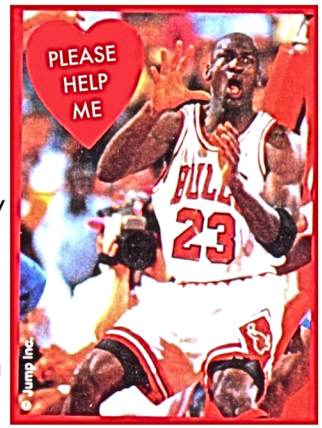
I'm the loneliest girl in the world
and my jaw's forever clenched
I can't make any friends
I think everyone's dumb as shit
I'm not really feeling my boyfriend
but he's my only friend
He doesn't like the taste of wine
and I can't with his parents.
So, now it's only my mom
I have a glass of wine with.
But, she's been out hustling
trying to pay the house
Ever since dad left.
Just trying to fill the burden
Of daddy's broken promises
I don't want to visit
I stay at my apartment
and control what I can
I've become a clean freak
And i think the roomies hate me
I took some gummies for sleep
But, my brain still wants to think
Sleep is the only solace I can get,
but I always get the morning shift.
Not all days are hard,
and I'm definitely not a pessimist,
I know how to be sweet,
but sometimes
I don't know if I'm bitter
Or the world is just sour.
Advil is my best friend now
And staying up only to the 23rd hour.

in the dark in my room

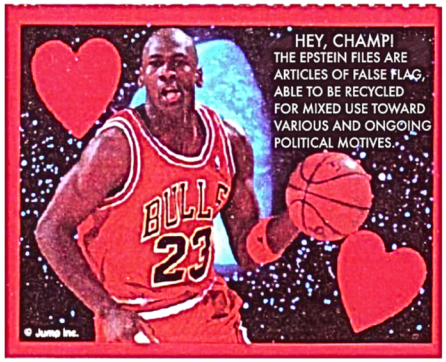


adriana and i lay on the bed, facing each other, but i'm thinking of laying here, in this same bed, with shelly. is adriana thinking about whether i've had another girl in my room, in this bed? does she care? would shelly care if she knew i were laying here with my cheek against adriana's forehead? i wish a mutual friend would tell shelly about me fingering adriana in my bed, but no one would because no one knows. truth is, if shelly knew about adriana, she'd be relieved and probably feel less guilty for being forced to ditch me when her parents sent her to michigan to live with her aunt. she didn't exactly say it, but i get the feeling she's somehow glad to have been raptured from her life, which includes me. even though all i did was try to be with her. adriana, on the other hand, likes me more than i like her–which is maybe why i like her. but i'm wondering if i can like someone who likes me more than i like them, if i don't even like myself? like, what's so wrong with her that she would like a person who doesn't like themself? does she actually like me more than i like her though? is that actually true? my intuition *always* feels right, yet here i am, in the dark...

have you told anybody about us? i ask adriana, then kiss the bridge of her nose.
are we together?
we're not *kind of dating*?
you don't even know anything about me, she says. i thought we were just going to
fuck. that seems like all you've wanted to do since we first hooked up,
which is honestly
fine to me.
sorry, i say.
why are you saying sorry? seriously, it's fine. just stop talking about it,
she says then sighs.
sorry, i say again, which makes her sigh again.



after laying in the dark for a bit, i try to cut the lingering awkward air by rubbing adriana's arm. she takes her shirt off and i continue rubbing until i feel a series of horizontal scars on the inside of her soft bicep. ten or fifteen of them, some still healing.
why did you do that? i ask her.
she mumbles something inaudible, then says, so i could stop feeling sorry for myself and take control of my pain–but i don't like to talk about this.
how does that control your pain?
i've already taken my shirt off. *this* is what you want to talk about?
for a moment, no one speaks, then she continues, i was tired of feeling pain from others, so i did it to myself, she says.
huh? i don't get it.
adriana unbuttons her jeans and pulls them down to her knees. the lights are out so i can't see much, but she takes my hand and places it on her outer thigh. i feel a scabby yet healing wound, almost as big as her whole thigh.
my dad found out i was on speed and got really mad, she says.
when were you on speed?
i'm always on it.
really?
yeah.
now?
no. but earlier, yeah. anyways, my dad pushed me out of the car.
that's a big scar.
the car was moving.
jesus.
he wasn't driving that fast. like i said, i'm tired of other people hurting me. I told my parents about how my uncle, who was living at our house, raped me and they didn't believe me. but then they also made him move out, but still never told me they believed me. so now it feels *good* to be the one–the *one* causing the pain.



are you too good to be with a girl who cuts herself?
i didn't say that.
then say something. i don't like to talk about this shit and now i'm uncomfortable and annoyed that you're judging me.
i'm not judging you...not in a bad way, at least. but hearing this makes me feel *weird*.
weird? why?
i don't know–it feels wrong to say why.
what could you say right now that would be worse than what i said?
i'm not supposed to be thinking what i'm thinking.
and i'm supposed to be thinking about how fucking good it feels good to cut myself? just fucking say it.
alright. i'm really fucking attracted to you right now.

adriana laughs for almost a full minute–so sincere of a laugh it becomes maniacal.
what the fuck is wrong with you? are you a fucking sadist or something? is this schaudenfreude? are you sexualizing my suffering?
sorry. it's not intentional. i'm just being honest. i am super turned on right now.
adriana touches me to see that i'm hard. i put my lips to hers for a kiss, and after a few seconds, i feel her tongue touching mine.

I carved and painted this pipe this past summer. I made it while recreating a pipe made by my great-grandfather that was carved during his time spent in Japanese internment camps during their occupation of Indonesia. Though I never had the opportunity to meet him, his journey, alongside my family who survived the war, has always resonated with me. Their story of immigrating to a country seeking refuge and better opportunities has now, more than ever, led me to reflect on immigrant identity. We live in tumultuous times, enduring the weight of an administration set to divide us and misconstrue American identity. No matter how you came to this country, you belong here.

One For All, Not For One:

Why Can't I Write?

thinking about all i need to do for my writing assignments, especially with the context of me often being behind what the scheduled class benchmarks are, inspires immediate and incessant thoughts of blame and shame and punishment; a guilt that asks if i'm trying to avoid the unpleasantness of the consequences i've seen for myself. but before things get to a point where i'm "behind," the things that lead me there are preemptive anxiety about how long the work will take, boredom with certain aspects of the writing process, and overall just poor time management. which all feel so trivial and easy to work on. begging the heavy question of "why are we still here?"

this mentality leads to a couple things:

a) i often forget (and leave no room for considering) that i have a brain whose configuration is medically recognized as struggling more with these facets of cognition, and how that may make the process of addressing it more complicated.

b) my mentals are being fucked with all the damn time!!! another part of me asks if i deserve to leave my mentals fucked with until i finish the thing causing me strife/"do the right thing." i probably don't, but it feels necessary in this fight-or-flight part of my brain that's always on.

and this whole ridiculous wave of bullshit crashes over me before i even start, so i often find i've tuckered myself out before i even do the thing that requires a lot of effort in the first place.

figuring out what works is all there is to it
so it seems

my difficulties
with self-love and self-compassion
were easier to conceptualize once i
realized that i grew up in a church,
in a school, in a community whose
fundamental belief is that you are
Born Bad and need to spend your
life constantly making up for that
fact. with greater clarity, i'm
able to see that this
is flawed. but i
still don'
t know where
to put the shame
most days.

give this
art some
LOVE